Build the Decision Pack

Use everything at once on Tallyrow's next quarter, and check it before you defend it.

Next quarter at Tallyrow, Maya wants smart reminders now, a competitor has launched "AI reminders", three agencies want multi-currency, the e-invoicing mandate's next phase has a date, and Tomás wants late fees. You have **ten person-months**.

Your decision pack has five parts. Each one uses a skill you have already practised, and the scorecard at the end is how you (or a colleague) can check it.

WHAT YOU ARE BUILDING

PART	WHAT IT ANSWERS	SKILL YOU ARE USING
1. The ranked quarter	What do we commit to, and in what order?	Two prioritisation models, reconciled; MoSCoW for the timebox; dates scheduled first
2. One idea, evaluated	Is the most contested idea worth building?	Assumption map and test card; Kano or product-market fit evidence
3. The metric tree	How will we know the quarter worked?	North Star, inputs and guardrails with limits
4. The experiment brief	How do we test the riskiest bet honestly?	Hypothesis, OEC, guardrails, unit, sample, window, decision rule
5. The one-page memo	What does Maya need to read before the meeting?	Inputs, not scores; the trade-off in plain view

PART 1 · THE RANKED QUARTER

1. **List every candidate** from the brief: the mandate's next phase, smart reminders (full build, or another test), multi-currency for agencies, late fees, the client portal, receipt capture, and anything the data pack shows that the brief does not name. *(Hint: read the funnel in the data pack carefully.)*
2. **Price the three lines of the bill** for the four most contested items: the slot (effort), the value (and how confident you are), and the weeks (cost of delay and urgency profile).
3. **Schedule date-bound work first.** For the mandate's next phase, write the deadline, the expected duration and the **last safe start week**. If it falls inside this quarter, it is in.
4. **Rank the rest with two models.** Pick one value model (RICE or weighted scoring) and one time model (CD3 or WSJF). Use the workbook tabs.
5. **Reconcile them.** Where the two rankings disagree, write one sentence on why: which line of the bill each model puts on top.
6. **Fit the timebox with MoSCoW.** Musts at or under about 60% of capacity, Coulds around 20%, Won't means "won't have this time".

WORKSHEET 1

ITEM	SLOT (PERSON-MONTHS)	VALUE + CONFIDENCE (AND ITS EVIDENCE)	WEEKS: COD RANGE AND PROFILE	MODEL A RANK	MODEL B RANK	MOSCOW

Reconciliation, one sentence per disagreement:

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Parts 2 and 3: one idea, evaluated, and the metric tree.

PART 2 · ONE IDEA, EVALUATED

Choose the most contested idea (most people will pick smart reminders; multi-currency is an equally good choice).

1. **Map its assumptions** on importance × evidence: desirability, feasibility, viability, adaptability.
2. **Label every piece of evidence you have** as *planned* or *unplanned*, and note its weaknesses (volunteers? no control group? one segment found after the fact?).
3. **Write the test card** for the top-right assumption: hypothesis, test, metric, and the pass criterion, **before** imagining the result.

WORKSHEET 2

Riskiest assumption:

Evidence so far (planned / unplanned, and weaknesses):

Test card: We believe...

To check, we will...

We will measure...

We are right if...

PART 3 · THE METRIC TREE

1. Start from Tallyrow's North Star, **invoices paid on time per week**, and its first level: sending businesses × invoices per business × on-time rate.
2. Go one level down on the branch your quarter is meant to move, and name the **input** each committed item should push.
3. Add **guardrails** with a baseline and a limit for each committed item, and the **agreed response** if one trips. Use the guardrail spec from measuring success for late fees if they are in your plan.

WORKSHEET 3

COMMITTED ITEM	INPUT IT SHOULD MOVE	GUARDRAIL	BASELINE	LIMIT	AGREED RESPONSE	OWNER

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Parts 4 and 5: the experiment brief and the memo.

PART 4 · THE EXPERIMENT BRIEF

Write the brief for the riskiest bet you are making (or for the test in Part 2).

WORKSHEET 4

Hypothesis (if… then… because…):

OEC:

Guardrails:

Unit of randomisation, and why:

Who is eligible:

Sample size (baseline, minimum detectable effect, significance, power) and the outcome window:

Decision rule: ship if… / stop if… / iterate if…

If an A/B test is the wrong tool here, which alternative, and why:

PART 5 · THE ONE-PAGE MEMO

Write it for Maya, who will read it on her phone before the meeting.

1. **The call** in three lines: Must, Should, Could, Won't (this time).
2. **The contested item** in four lines: its inputs, the line of the bill they price, the cheapest test that would change them, and when the answer arrives.
3. **What it costs** to do it her way instead: what drops out, and what that risks.
4. **How you'll know** it worked: the inputs and guardrails, and the date of the first readout.

THE MEMO

The call:

The contested item:

What it costs to do it her way:

How you'll know:

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The scorecard.

SCORECARD · CHECK YOUR PACK BEFORE THE DEFENCE

#	CHECK	✓
1	Every date-bound item has a last safe start week, and the plan respects it	☐
2	Two models used; every disagreement explained by the line of the bill each puts on top	☐
3	Musts at or under about 60% of capacity; Won't items named "this time"	☐
4	Every confidence value has its evidence written next to it	☐
5	Unplanned evidence (for example a segment found after the fact) is treated as a hypothesis	☐
6	The test card's pass criterion was written before any result	☐
7	Every committed item has an input metric and a guardrail with a limit and an agreed response	☐
8	The experiment brief names its unit of randomisation and outcome window	☐
9	The memo leads with inputs, not scores, and states the cost of the alternative	☐
10	Nothing in the pack relies on a number you can't trace to the data pack	☐

When every row has a tick, watch the defence and compare your pack with the worked answer.

WHAT YOU NEED OPEN

The **brief**, the **data pack** and the **scorecard** attached to the brief; the **Tallyrow prioritisation workbook** for the model tabs; and the **decision-pack worksheet** attached here, if you'd rather type than print.